California National Parks: How Can They Drive More Visitors?

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Over 36.2 million people visit California National Parks per year...

BUT SOME PARKS STRUGGLE WITH VISITATION WHILE OTHERS DON'T. WHY?

What Factors Need To Be Examined?

3 Important Factors

1 – Area (in km^2)

2 – Geolocation

3 – Budget (in thousands of dollars)

Categorical List Data For All California National Parks

The Advantages of Categorical List Data Are…

1) Simplistic interpretation
2) Effective Visuals
3) Efficient comparisons

Process Of Examination

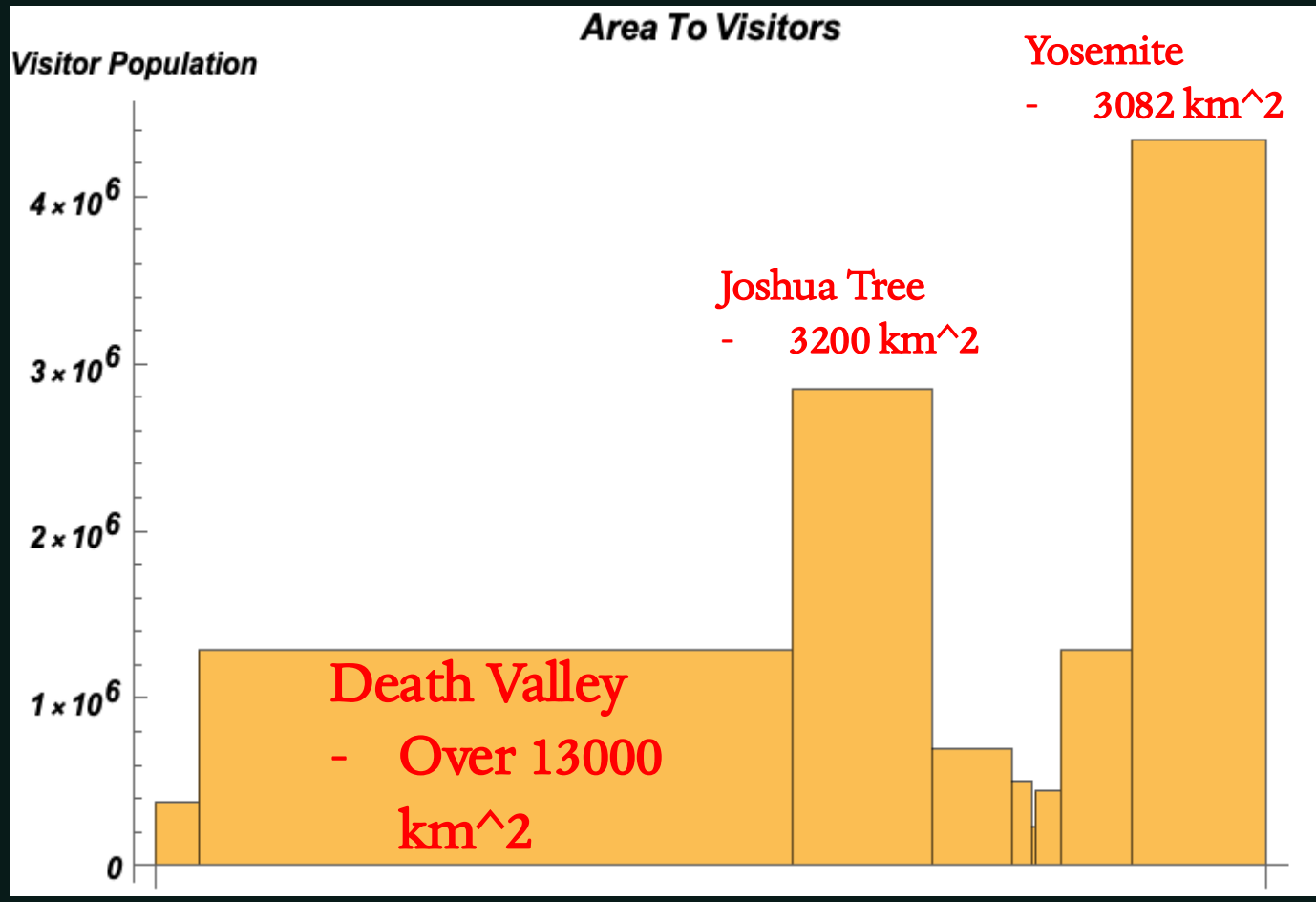
Area and Visitation statistics are important towards this question because it highlights how the park me underutilizing its space

Area To Visits

California Parks: Area To Visitation

THE DETAILS

- General trend of larger visitation with larger area
- Death Valley a bit over 50% of the total area of all California National Parks
- This outlier in the data funding broken down trails under harsh environment
- Underused Potential Area



Process Of Examination

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Geolocation

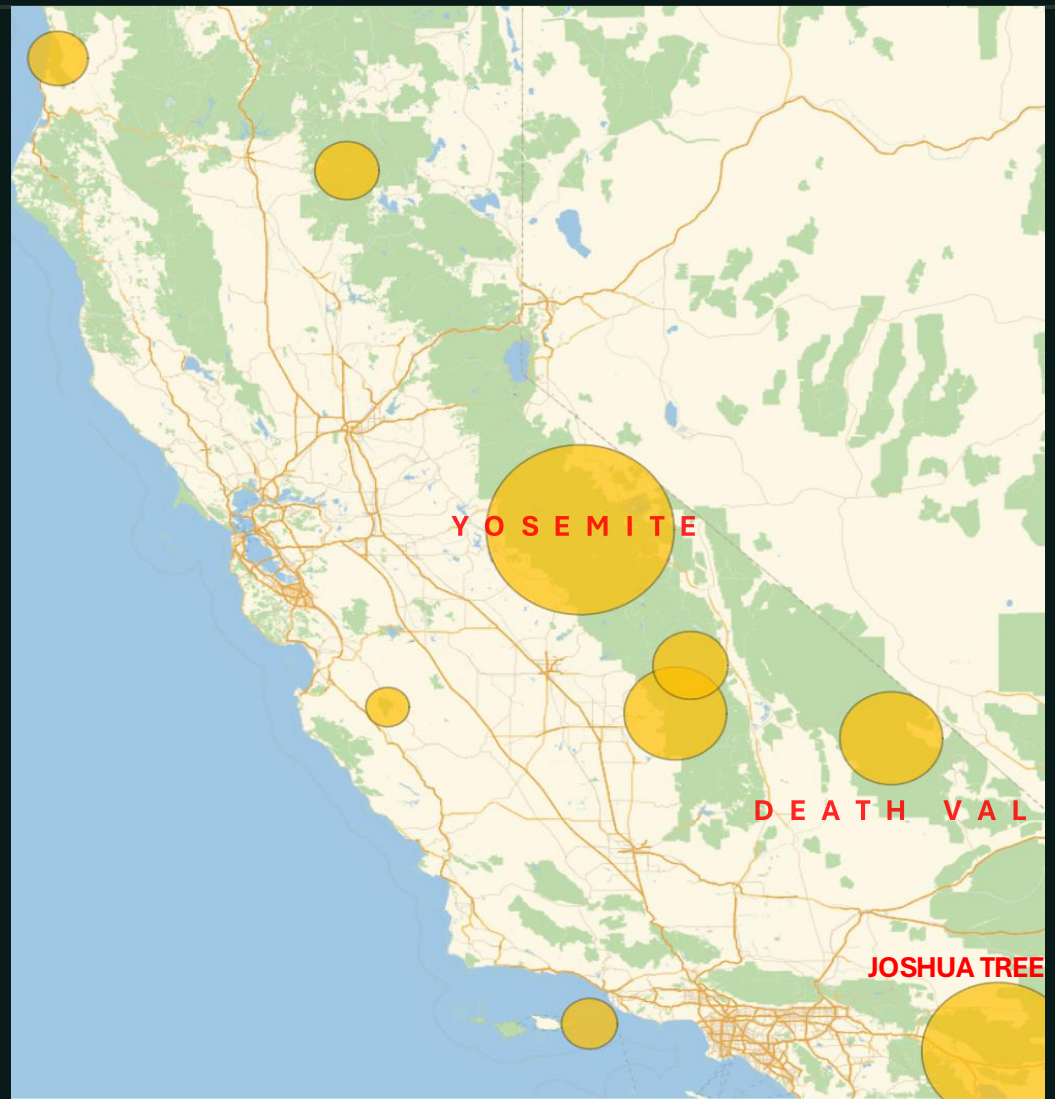
Area

Because some more popular parks are closer to larger cities it drives visitation to them, skipping other parks that may be further

California Parks: Geolocation To Visitation

THE DETAILS

- Major parks closer to major cities like San Francisco or Los Angeles getting most visitation
- Yosemite, Death Valley, Joshua Tree
- This could influence the decision to advertise for less desirable parks that are similar proximities



Process Of Examination

Area and Visitation statistics are important towards this question because it highlights how the park me underutilizing its space

Looking at the budget to visitor relationship, parks with less funding receive less attention which may influence allocation of funds to them by the government

Geolocation

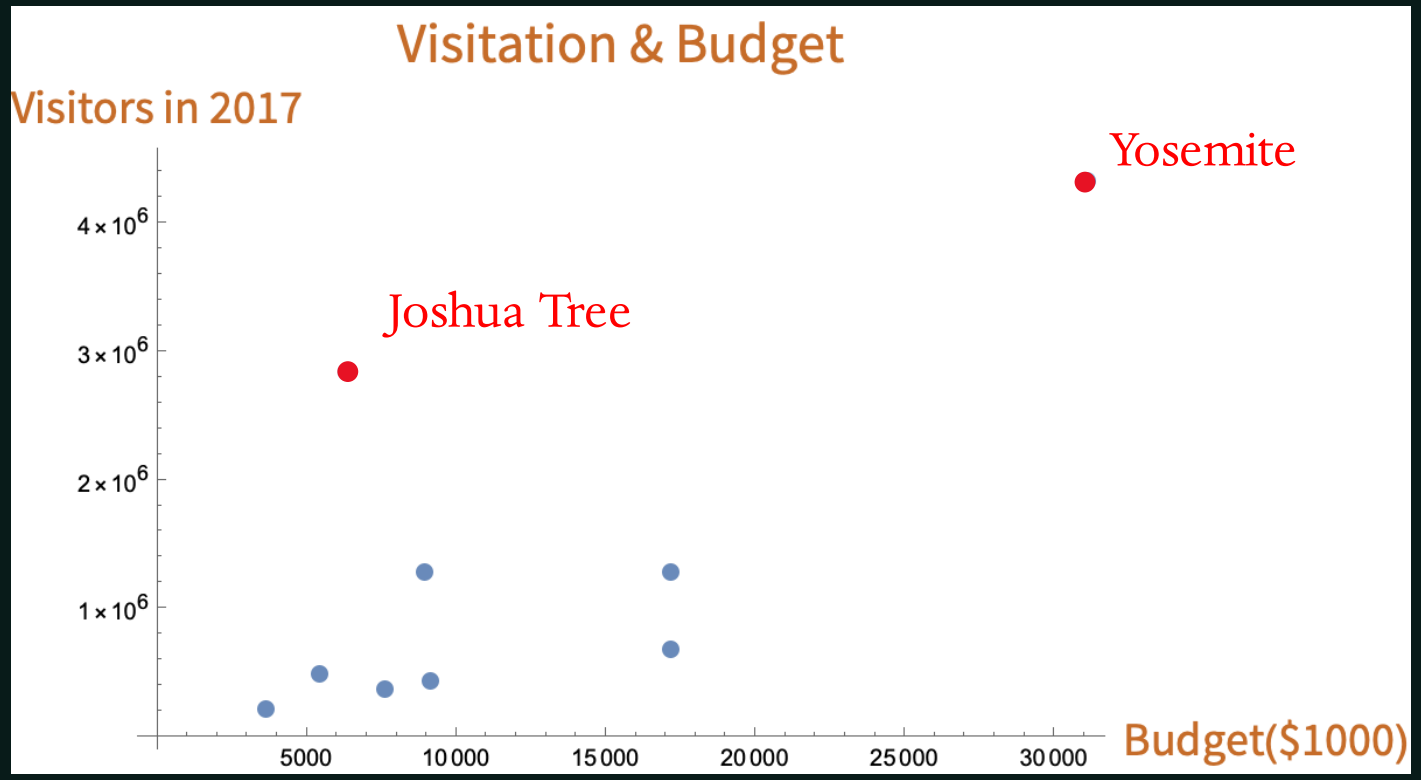
Area

Budget

Because some more popular parks are closer to larger cities it drives visitation to them, skipping other parks that may be further

California Parks: Budget To Visitation

- Higher budget correlated with high visitation
- Where are the outliers?
- Visitation/$1000
  - Highest efficiency: Joshua Tree, Death Valley, Yosemite
  - Lowest efficiency: Kings Canyon, Redwood, Channel Islands
- Where to invest?
  - Marketing, Infrastructure, Access



"How Can Data Effect Decision Making Within California Parks"

1) The data for area can call for decisions regarding funds being allocated towards restoration and upkeep in parks with higher areas.
2) The data for geolocation can be used to decide the advertisement funding for under visited parks
3) The data for budget can be used to help decide which parks lack funding for development and employee salary

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